WHAT'S HAPPENING IN JAX

March 2026

JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA · THE FIRST COAST

Spring has arrived!

62°–78°F

Average Temps

ONLINE VERSION

MARQUEE EVENT OF THE MONTH

THE PLAYERS Championship

March 10–15 · TPC Sawgrass, Ponte Vedra Beach — Golf's premier event with the world's strongest field on Pete Dye's Stadium Course. Military Appreciation Day (Mar 10) features a **Ludacris concert** at the iconic 17th hole. Taste of Jax village, family zones, and the Island Green replica challenge on-site. Tickets at **theplayers.com**

EARLY MARCH · MARCH 1–8

SUNDAY, MARCH 1 · 3 PM

Icemen vs. Everblades

ECHL hockey at VyStar Veterans Memorial Arena. One of the largest fan bases in minor league hockey. Bring a jacket — it drops to 54°F inside!

VyStar Arena, Downtown · icemen.com

WEDNESDAY, MARCH 4 · 5–9 PM

First Wednesday ArtWalk

Free self-guided gallery walk through downtown since 2003. Open studios, live music, pop-up exhibits, food trucks. Hub at James Weldon Johnson Park.

Downtown Jacksonville · Free Admission

FRIDAY–SUNDAY, MARCH 6–8

Home + Patio Show

375 exhibitors and 30,000+ attendees. Home improvement, outdoor living, kitchen design, and garden inspiration. One of the largest home shows in the Southeast.

Prime Osborn Convention Center · jacksonvillespringhomeshow.com

SATURDAY, MARCH 7 · 8 AM

Gate River Run 15K

The nation's largest 15K and US National 15K Championship since 1994. 20,000+ runners cross the legendary Hart Bridge. Runners Expo March 5–6 at the Convention Center.

Downtown Jacksonville · gateriverrun15k.com

SATURDAY, MARCH 7 · 4–8 PM

Jax Food & Wine Festival

25+ chefs and restaurants beneath the Fuller Warren Bridge at Artist Walk. Unlimited tastings, craft beverages, and live music by Disco Cowboy & Chris Thomas Project.

Artist Walk, Riverside · Tickets on Eventbrite

EVERY SATURDAY · 10 AM–3 PM

Riverside Arts Market

100+ local artists, food trucks, live music under the Fuller Warren Bridge. Free admission, rain or shine. On March 7, shelter dogs available for adoption!

Under Fuller Warren Bridge, Riverside · Free

Live Music · Early March: John Oates at Ponte Vedra Concert Hall (Mar 3, 7:30pm) · **Home Free** at Ponte Vedra Concert Hall (Mar 4, 7:30pm) · **Christopher Cross** at Florida Theatre (Mar 5, 8pm) · **RENT in Concert** at Florida Theatre (Mar 10, 7:30pm) · **Bronx Wanderers** at Florida Theatre (Mar 11)

MARCH WEATHER

One of the best months to visit Jacksonville. Warm days in the mid-70s, cool nights in the low 60s, low humidity, and minimal rain. Perfect for outdoor dining, beach days, golf, and exploring the city on foot. Pack layers for evenings.

March 2026 — Continued

Mid & late month events

MID MARCH · MARCH 9-15

TUESDAY-SUNDAY, MARCH 10-15

THE PLAYERS Championship

See featured event on page 1. The world's premier golf tournament at TPC Sawgrass. Ludacris concert on Military Appreciation Day (Mar 10). Taste of Jax village on-site.

TPC Sawgrass, Ponte Vedra Beach · theplayers.com

FRIDAY-SATURDAY, MARCH 13-14

Jax Horror Film Festival

Inaugural "First Blood" themed horror festival. Two days of indie horror screenings, celebrity judges, panels, awards ceremony, and a vendor market with art and collectibles.

Hicks Auditorium, Downtown Library · jaxhorrorfilmfest.com

FRI MARCH 13, SAT 14 & SUN 15

Icemen Triple Header Weekend

Three home games in three days! vs. Swamp Rabbits (Fri 7pm), vs. Everblades (Sat 7pm), vs. Everblades (Sun 3pm). Best entertainment value in Jax.

VyStar Veterans Memorial Arena · icemen.com

SATURDAY, MARCH 14

St. Patrick's Day Celebrations

Jax Beach parade & block party, Five Points pub crawl, and downtown Irish Fest. Green beer flows throughout the First Coast all weekend long.

Jax Beach, Five Points & Downtown

LATE MARCH · MARCH 16-31

FRIDAY, MARCH 20 · 7 PM

Icemen vs. Gladiators

Friday night hockey at VyStar Arena. Grab a beer, watch the fights, enjoy the atmosphere. Also: Mar 22 vs. Swamp Rabbits (Sun 3pm).

VyStar Veterans Memorial Arena · icemen.com

SATURDAY, MARCH 21

Jax Food Fest & Craft Fair

Local food vendors, craft artisans, and live entertainment. Sample the city's diverse culinary scene in one spot. Family-friendly outdoor event.

Jacksonville · Check Eventbrite for details

FRIDAY-SUNDAY, MARCH 27-29

CollectiveCon

North Florida's premier anime, comic book, sci-fi & pop culture convention. Celebrity guests, cosplay contests, panels, hundreds of vendors, and a free arcade room.

Prime Osborn Convention Center · collectivecon.com

FRIDAY, MARCH 27 · OPENING DAY

Jumbo Shrimp Opening Day

The 2025 Triple-A champs raise their championship banner! First home game vs. Rochester Red Wings. Championship ring ceremony. Tickets from $5.

VyStar Ballpark, Downtown · jaxshrimp.com

Live Music · Late March: Brit Floyd — "The Dark Side of the Moon & The Wall" at Florida Theatre (Mar 28, 7:30pm). A breathtaking tribute to Pink Floyd's greatest albums. Tickets at floridatheatre.com

Right Whale Season (Final Weeks): North Atlantic right whales — one of Earth's rarest species with fewer than 350 remaining — are still spotted off Jacksonville's coast through March. Watch from Jax Beach or book a boat tour. · **Ravine Gardens Azalea Trail** in Palatka (1 hr south) hits peak bloom mid-March. 100,000+ azaleas line dramatic ravine trails. $6 park entry — stunning photo ops.

MARCH DINING TIP

THE PLAYERS Championship week transforms Ponte Vedra into a foodie destination. Many top Jax restaurants set up pop-ups at the **Taste of Jax Village** inside the tournament gates. It's a great way to sample the city's best chefs in one spot — with world-class golf as the backdrop. Pro tip: the **Gate River Run after-party** on March 7 is a massive downtown celebration worth attending even if you don't run.